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EU AI Act

Finland

Country Profile

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Sean Musch, Michael Borrelli, Charles Kerrigan, Turo Manninen, Minna Saonegin, Andrey Prozorov, Paavo Ritala



Foreword



**Andrey
Prozorov**

*Information
Security Officer,
Finom*



Minna Saonegin

*Director,
CGI*



**Turo
Manninen**

*Co-Founder,
HR2Y OY*



Paavo Ritala

*Professor of
Strategy &
Innovation,
LUT Univeristy*

In many domains, artificial intelligence (AI) is moving from experimentation to real deployment, reshaping regulation, innovation and public-sector capability. This country profile examines how Finland is preparing for the EU Artificial Intelligence Act, highlighting progress in data governance, high-performance computing and responsible AI adoption across

sectors such as health, mobility and the bioeconomy. Key challenges remain: expanding supervisory capacity, clarifying requirements for SMEs, strengthening conformity pathways and ensuring transparency. By investing in skills, coordination and shared standards, Finland can ensure AI supports anticipatory, trustworthy and resilient governance.

AI Without a Name? The Invisible Layer That Challenges the Boundaries of Regulation

Many Finnish organisations already make use of AI-based solutions, for example in recruitment, competence assessment, or employee experience management, without these systems being explicitly recognised as “artificial intelligence.” This creates a phenomenon that could be called invisible AI: systems that influence decisions but remain outside documentation, impact assessment, and regulatory frameworks.

This practical grey zone is critical. It is precisely within these systems that risks to transparency, fairness and accountability may arise, especially when they directly affect people and their opportunities.

Organisations are not necessarily acting irresponsibly. More often, the issue is that the AI nature of certain systems is not recognised, or that evaluation practices have not yet been developed. This points to one of the major practical challenges in AI governance: how to guide development in a context where the boundaries of AI are not technical, but cultural.



**Turo
Manninen**
Co-Founder,
HR2Y OY